

Aeonis: First Playable

Low-ink reference kit - synchronized 2026-07-13

WHAT THIS PDF CONTAINS

- Deterministic setup maps for 3-8 players
- Eight launch-Lord reference sheets
- A reusable player board
- The current Player Aid

PRINTING

Print at 100% on US Letter paper. Print the player-board page once per player. Lord sheets and maps are table references, not replacements for the owning Markdown chapters.

ALSO REQUIRED

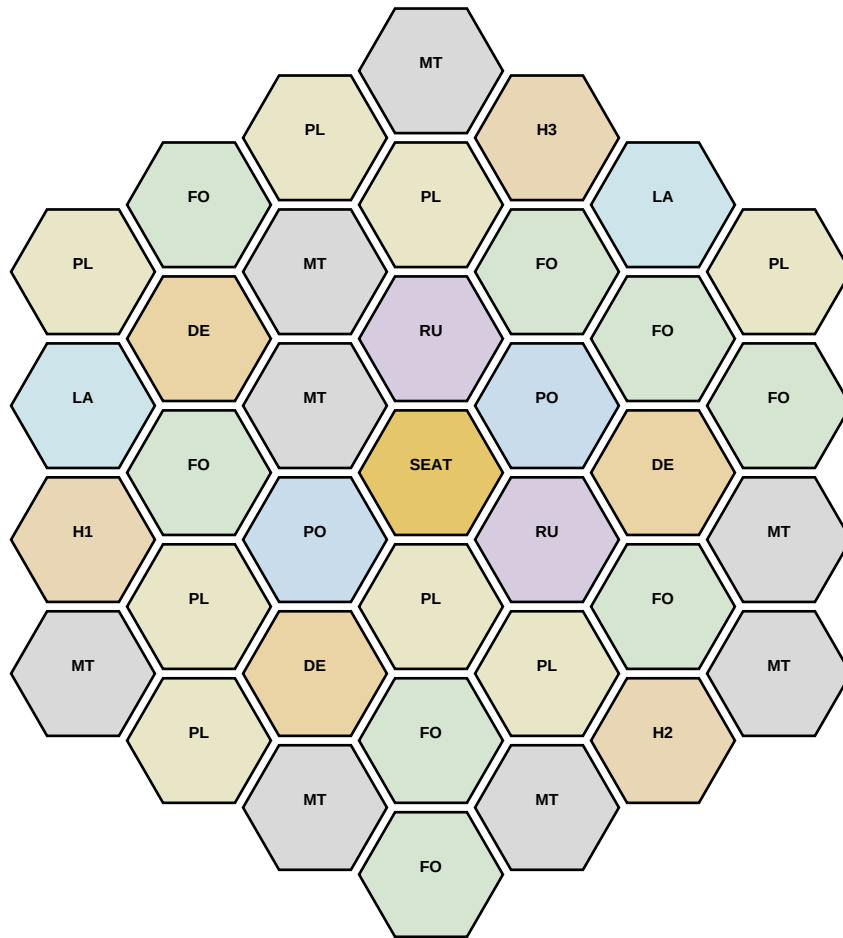
Cards PDF, tokens/map-proxies PDF, polyhedral dice (d4/d6/d8/d10), pencils or cubes, and sleeves/cardstock as desired.

CANON

Round_Structure.md owns timing. System chapters own their rules. First_Playable_Packet.md owns explicit First Playable overrides. Generated PDFs are derived artifacts.

3-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure

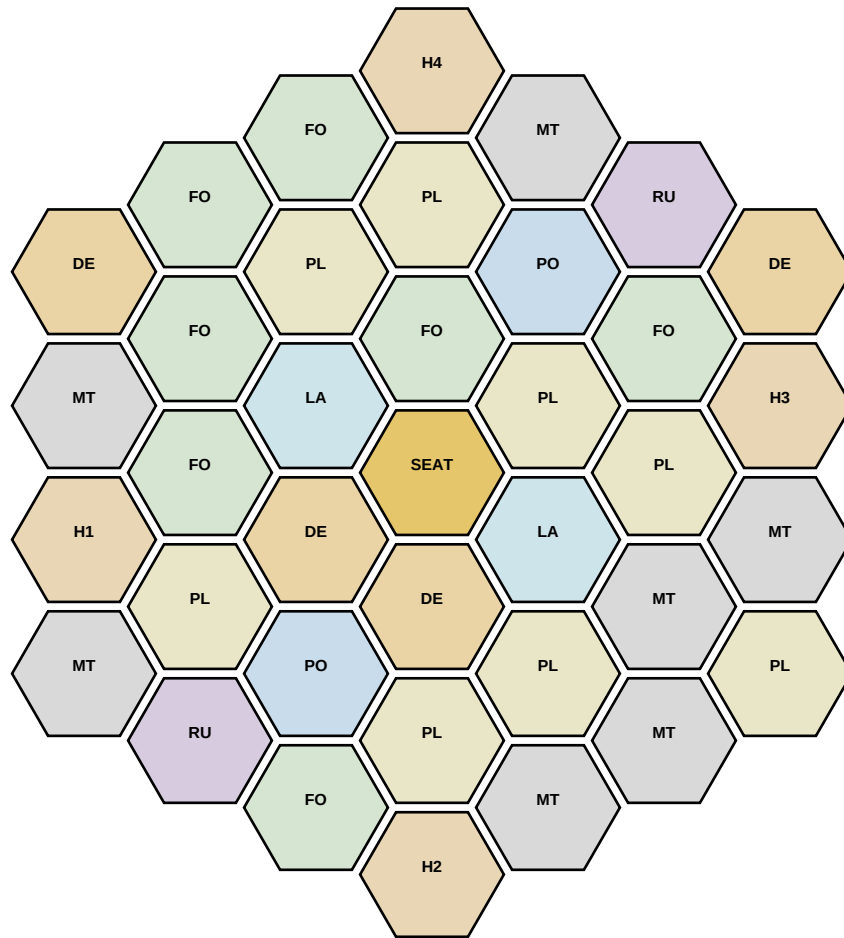


Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

4-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure

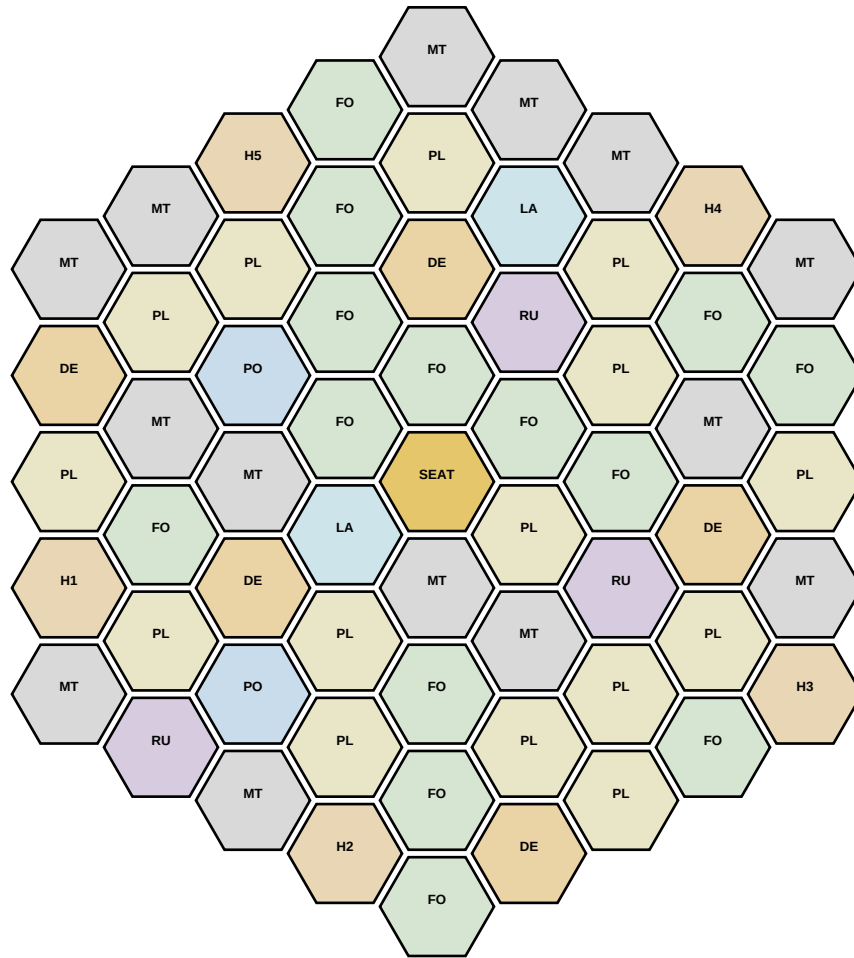


Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

5-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure

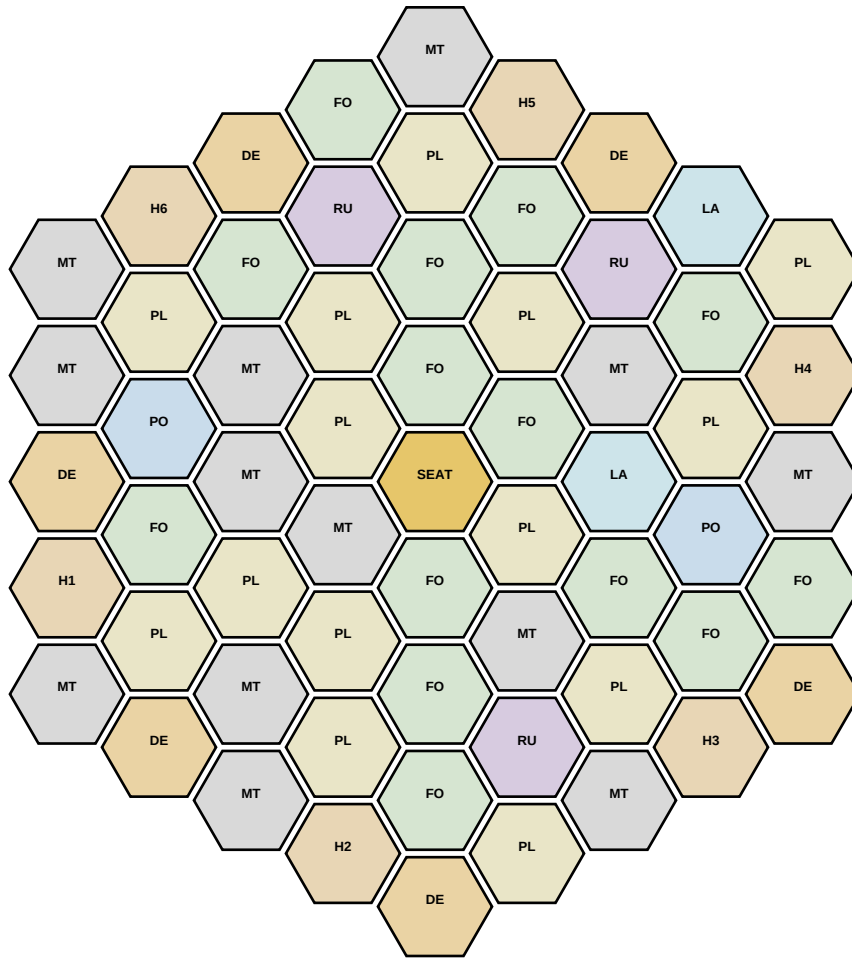


Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

6-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure

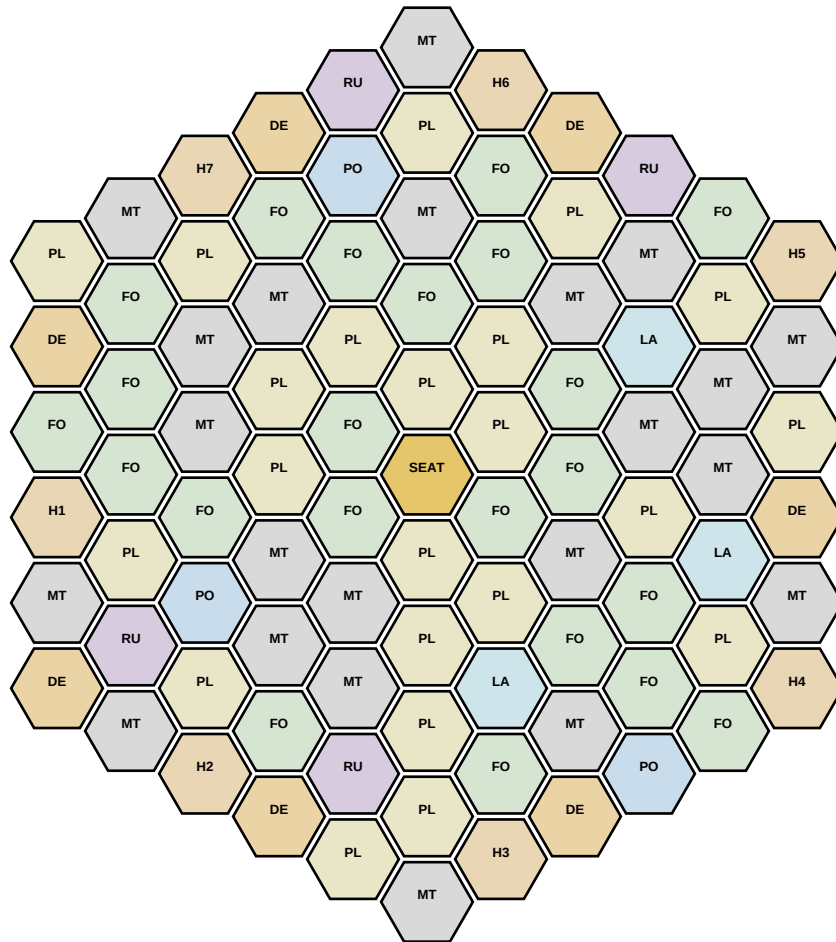


Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

7-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure

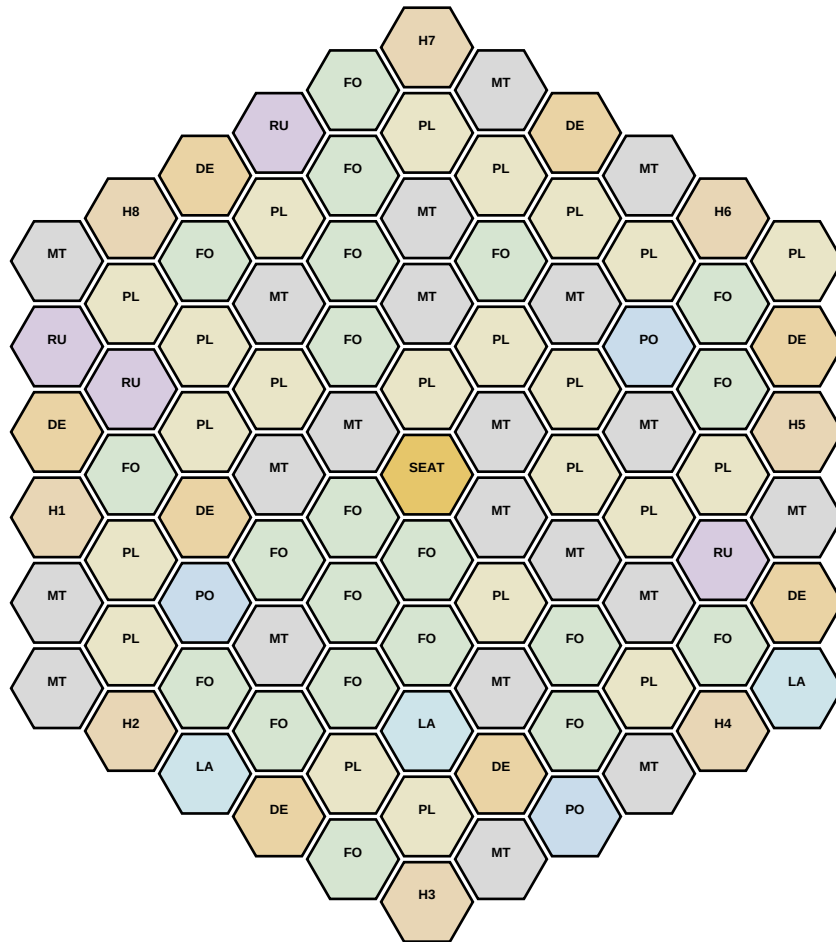


Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

8-Player Preset Map

Deterministic PnP layout generated by the simulator's canonical hexmap procedure



Legend: PL Plains | FO Forest | MT Mountain | DE Desert | RU Ruins | PO Portal | LA Lake | H# Home City

Assign H1-H# in Speaker order. Apply each Lord's Unique Starting Tile substitution after laying out the map.

Lord Sheet: Cassian, the Merchant Prince

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Cassian (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d8
- Health: 3
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: Cassian is a dealmaker, not a duelist. Modest offense, solid self-preservation.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 3
Mana: 2
Influence: 2

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR DESERT)

Caravan Bazaar (counts as Desert)

- Production: +2 Influence
- Building permissions: You may build an Embassy here, but you may not build a Tower here.
- Controller benefit: When a player initiates a Trade at 0 AP (e.g., via Market), the controller of Caravan Bazaar gains +1 Gold (max once per round).

ABILITIES

1) THE CONSORTIUM'S LEDGER (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: Once per round, during any player's turn in the Action Phase, before or after that player's action resolves.

Effect: You may initiate one Trade at 0 AP, even when it is not your turn. Resolve the Trade before play continues. In addition, once per round during the High Council Phase, when a deal you proposed is accepted, you may declare its one included promise about the current motion's

vote binding. The promised player must vote as agreed when that motion resolves.

Limits: The off-turn Trade and binding vote promise are each usable once per round. A Ledger deal cannot bind future resource production, movement, combat, or a later round.

Theme: You do not visit the market. You are the market.

2) COUNCIL PATRONAGE (FACTION MECHANIC)

Effect: Once per round, after a High Council vote resolves, if you spent any Influence on Lobbying for that vote, gain +1 Gold.

Theme: Every public favor has a private invoice.

3) LETTERS OF CREDIT (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Effect: Once per round, at any time during the High Council Phase, you may spend 1 Influence to gain +2 Gold.

Cost: 1 Influence

Theme: When the chamber is loud, money moves fastest.

FACTION RESEARCH (GOLDEN CONSORTIUM)

GUILD CONTRACTS

Cost: 2 Gold, 2 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Your Market build cost is reduced by 1 Gold (minimum 0). In addition, once per round when you initiate a Trade at 0 AP via a Market, gain +1 Influence.

Theme: Trade is infrastructure-and infrastructure is leverage.

DIPLOMATIC TARIFFS

Cost: 3 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Once per round, when another player initiates a Trade, you may gain +1 Gold if you control at least one Embassy on the map.

Theme: You tax the roads you "keep safe."

LEGENDARY BUILDING: GRAND EXCHANGE

- Prerequisite: Control 2 Markets and have 8+ Gold in reserve.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 6 Gold, 3 Influence
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: PRODUCTION: Gain +1 Gold for each Trade action completed this round (by any player, including trades with you). Once per round, you may initiate a Trade at 0 AP (in addition to any Market benefit).

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "COINS AND CROWNS"

End a round with 10 Gold OR win a Title in the High Council.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "MONOPOLY"

At Cleanup & Checks, control Caravan Bazaar and have at least one Embassy in play.

Lord Sheet: Seraphel, Lord of the Arcane

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Seraphel (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d10
- Defense: d6
- Health: 3
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: Devastating arcane strikes, fragile body. High-risk, high-reward in combat.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 1
Mana: 4
Influence: 1

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR FOREST)

Arcane Nexus (counts as Forest)

- Production: +2 Mana
- Building permissions: You may build a Tower here, but you may not build a Grove here.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): Once per round, reduce the Mana cost of one Arcane Discovery you research by 1 (minimum 0).

ABILITIES

1) POLYMATH (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: When checking a Discovery's prerequisites, and once per round after you resolve a Research action on your turn in the Action Phase.

Effect: Count as having one additional sigil in every Arcane school when checking prerequisites. After you resolve a Research action, you may immediately take a second Research action in the same turn, paying its full AP and resource costs.

Limits: The bonus sigils satisfy prerequisites only; they are not Discoveries and grant no printed effects. The second Research action is optional and usable once per round.

Theme: You research as though the empire never fell.

2) SCRY THE COUNCIL (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: At the start of the High Council Phase, you may look at the top card of the agenda deck (First Playable rule) and put it back.

Theme: Your diviners hear the argument before it is spoken.

3) BLINK STEP (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Seraphel must be part of the moving group.

Effect: Once per round, when you take a Move action, you may spend 2 Mana. If you do, treat Mountains and Deserts as costing 1 AP per hex for that Move action (instead of 2 AP per hex).

Cost: 2 Mana

Theme: A step across ley lines is faster than any road.

FACTION RESEARCH (ARCANUM CONCORD)

MANA NEXUS (LORD-SPECIFIC DISCOVERY)

Cost: 4 Mana, 1 Gold (Research action)

Effect: Your controlled Mana-producing hexes (Forests/Groves/unique Mana tiles) produce +1 additional Mana.

Theme: You widen the conduits; the land itself becomes a focus.

SPELLWEAVE DOCTRINE

Cost: 2 Mana, 2 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Once per round, after you lobby on a High Council vote (spend any Influence during Lobbying), gain 1 Mana.

Theme: Politics is just another ritual circle.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: ARCANESANCTUM

- Prerequisite: Complete 3 Arcane Discoveries (any school).
- Build cost: 4 AP + 4 Gold, 6 Mana
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: PRODUCTION: Gain +2 Mana. Once per round, you may Research a Tier I discovery for free (0 AP, 0 resources). Your Lord gains +1 Attack die size while in this hex.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "RITUAL ASCENDANCE"

End a round with 10 Mana and control at least 2 Forest/Grove hexes.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "CALCULATED VIOLENCE"

In a single round, resolve Press the Attack at least twice across your attacks (this can be across multiple Attack actions), and win at least one of those battles.

Lord Sheet: Vharok, the Lord of Steel

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 3 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- Notes: Baseline unit (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Vharok (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d8
- Defense: d10
- Health: 4
- Movement Range: 1
- Design note: The immovable wall. Extremely durable but slow; rewards committing him to a front line rather than roaming.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 4
Mana: 1
Influence: 1

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR MOUNTAIN)

Ironworks Ridge (counts as Mountain)

- Production: +2 Gold
- Building permissions: You may build a Fortress here. If you build a Mine here, reduce its Gold build cost by 1.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): Once per round, when you build a Fortress, reduce its Gold cost by 1 (minimum 0).

ABILITIES

1) FORGED IN BATTLE (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: When defending a hex that contains one of your buildings, your units gain +1 Defense. (Add +1 to their Defense rolls in that battle.)
Theme: Steel discipline behind walls and fortifications.

2) BASTION DOCTRINE (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: When you become the defender in a battle at a hex you control that contains one of your buildings.

Effect: You may Hold the Walls in that hex even if it is not a City or Fortress. Its Battle Line cap is +1 for your defending side for that battle.

Limits: If you Hold the Walls, normal Siege rules and retreat restrictions apply. Losing control of the hex ends the exception.
Theme: Every workshop, tower, and mine is a keep.

3) LOCK THE LINE (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Vharok must be committed to this battle.
Effect: Once per battle round, after targets are declared but before any dice are rolled, you may spend 1 Mana to reassign up to two of the attacker's declared targets (the attacker chooses new legal targets for those units).
Cost: 1 Mana
Theme: Shield walls and battlefield control-your defenders force the enemy into bad trades.

FACTION RESEARCH (IRON DOMINION)

REINFORCED FORTIFICATIONS

Cost: 3 Gold, 1 Mana (Research action)
Effect: Your units defending a Tower hex gain an additional +1 Defense (stacks with the Tower's +1).
Theme: Runes, braces, and iron geometry turning positions into bastions.

SIEGE LOGISTICS

Cost: 2 Gold, 2 Influence (Research action)
Effect: Once per round, after you resolve an Attack action against a City/Fortress, gain +1 AP (this AP must be spent this round).
Theme: Supply lines and disciplined rotations keep the pressure constant.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: IRON CITADEL

- Prerequisite: Control at least 1 Fortress.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 10 Gold, 2 Mana
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: This City is treated as a Fortress (Siege rules apply to attackers; see Combat.md). Units defending this hex gain +3 Defense.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "UNBROKEN LINE"

Control a Fortress hex and win a battle where you are the defender.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "IRON GRIP"

At Cleanup & Checks, control 2 or more hexes that each contain one of your buildings.

Lord Sheet: Elyndra, Warden of Groves

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Elyndra (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d8
- Health: 4
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: Resilient guardian. High HP rewards staying in fights; modest offense reflects attrition-over-burst playstyle.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 2
Mana: 3
Influence: 1

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR FOREST)

Sacred Grove (counts as Forest)

- Production: +1 Mana and +1 Population
- Building permissions: You may build a Tower here, but you may not build a Grove here.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): At the end of Production & Upkeep, gain +1 Population Pool (up to cap).

ABILITIES

1) THE DEEP ROOTS (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: Once per round, when you take a Move action on your turn in the Action Phase.

Effect: Choose one of your unit groups in a Forest hex you control and another Forest hex you control. For this Move, treat those hexes as adjacent; moving the group between them costs 1 AP.

Limits: The destination must be legal and the group must begin and end in the chosen Forests. This is not Portal travel and does not cross intervening hexes.

Theme: Every grove is part of one living forest.

2) ROOTED DEFENSES (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: Once per battle round, when defending in a Forest/Grove hex, you may reroll one Defense die.

Theme: Familiar terrain and living cover turn mistakes into survivals.

3) ENTANGLING ROOTS (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Elyndra must be committed to this battle.

Effect: Once per battle round while you are defending in a Forest/Grove hex, after an enemy unit rolls its Attack die, you may spend 1 Mana to apply -2 to that roll (minimum 1).

Cost: 1 Mana

Theme: Vines snag blades, branches pull arms wide, and momentum dies mid-swing.

FACTION RESEARCH (VERDANT COVENANT)

THORNWATCH

Cost: 3 Mana, 1 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Your Archers on the Battle Line defending a Forest/Grove hex gain +1 Defense (add +1 to their Defense rolls).

Theme: Camouflaged sentries and killing lanes through the canopy.

SEEDBOUND RESILIENCE

Cost: 2 Mana, 2 Gold (Research action)

Effect: Once per round, after a battle ends in a hex you control, you may gain +1 Population Pool (up to cap).

Theme: The grove regrows faster than the war can burn it.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: HEARTWOOD SANCTUM

- Prerequisite: Reach Population Cap of 15+.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 3 Gold, 4 Mana, 2 Influence
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: PRODUCTION: +3 Population growth at this hex. Adjacent hexes you control produce +1 of their primary resource. Units in this hex regenerate 1 HP at Round Start.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "GREEN DOMINION"

Control 3 Forest/Grove hexes at Cleanup & Checks.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "HOLDFAST"

Win a battle as the defender in a Forest/Grove hex, then end the round still controlling that hex.

Lord Sheet: Rakhis, the Sandlord

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Cavalry
- Attack: d8
- Defense: d6
- Health: 2
- Notes: Cavalry have Movement Range 2 and ignore ZOC penalty on first ZOC hex per Move (see Movement.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Rakhis (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d8
- Defense: d6
- Health: 3
- Movement Range: 3
- Design note: The fastest Lord on the board. Fragile defenses force him to use speed, not armor, to survive.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 3
Mana: 1
Influence: 2

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 6

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR PLAINS)

Oasis Wellspring (counts as Plains)

- Production: +1 Population and +1 Gold
- Building permissions: You may build a Farm here, but you may not build a Tower here.

ABILITIES

1) SANDSTRIDE (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: During your Move actions, and once per battle before the first Pre-Strike step resolves.

Effect: Your groups treat Deserts as costing 1 AP per hex. Once per battle, before the first Pre-Strike step, you may retreat your committed group using the normal attacker or defender retreat destination rules.

Limits: Sandstride does not permit a defender to retreat from a City, Fortress, or a hex where it chose to Hold the Walls. Sandstride does not

ignore enemy ZOC surcharges (removed 2026-07-12 - balance ladder Dial 3); Cavalry still use the normal first-ZOC flanking exemption. (Dial 3b retreat removal was tried and reverted the same day - metrics regressed.)

Theme: You cannot pin the wind.

2) HIT AND RUN (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: Once per game, when you win a battle as the attacker, your surviving committed units may immediately move 1 hex to any adjacent hex you control or any adjacent neutral hex. This movement does not cost AP and does not count as a Move action.

Theme: The Horde strikes and vanishes before the dust settles.

3) DESERT TEMPEST (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Rakhis must be within 2 hexes of the chosen Desert.

Effect: Once per round during the Action Phase, spend 2 Mana. Choose one Desert hex you control. Until end of round, that hex costs +2 additional AP for other players to enter (total 4 AP for opponents).

Cost: 2 Mana

Theme: Wind and sand become a wall when Rakhis commands them.

FACTION RESEARCH (WINDSWORN HORDE)

MIRAGE RIDERS

Cost: 3 Gold, 1 Mana (Research action)

Effect: Your Cavalry gain +1 Attack (add +1 to their Attack rolls) when attacking from a Desert hex (the hex they committed from is a Desert).

Theme: Heat shimmer and speed make the charge impossible to read.

SANDSWORN PACT

Cost: 2 Influence, 2 Gold (Research action)

Effect: Once per round, when you claim a neutral hex by moving a unit into it, gain +1 Gold.

Theme: Every new territory is a trade route waiting to open.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: WINDSWORN WARCAMP

- Prerequisite: Win 2 battles as the attacker.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 5 Gold, 3 Influence
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: Units recruited at this City gain +1 Movement for their first move each round. Once per round, one Cavalry unit group may take a free Move action (1 hex) at 0 AP.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "ENDLESS HORIZON"

Control 3 Desert hexes at Cleanup & Checks.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "LIGHTNING RAID"

Win a battle as attacker and use Hit and Run to move your units afterward in the same round.

Lord Sheet: Nyxara, the Veiled

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Nyxara (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d10
- Defense: d4
- Health: 2
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: The ultimate glass cannon. A devastating strike but the most fragile Lord in the game -- she kills or she dies.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 2
Mana: 2
Influence: 2

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR MOUNTAIN)

Obsidian Spire (counts as Mountain)

- Production: +1 Gold and +1 Mana
- Building permissions: You may build a Mine here, but you may not build a Tower here.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): At Round Start, draw 1 additional Whisper Card (stacks with the Whisper Network ability for a total of 4 draws at Round Start).

ABILITIES

1) WHISPER NETWORK (FACTION MECHANIC)

Effect: Draw 3 Whisper Cards at Round Start instead of the standard 2. Your hand limit is 8 instead of the standard 7.
Theme: The Umbral hear more whispers than anyone -- and forget none of them.

2) SHADOW SIGHT (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: Once per round, when another player plays a Whisper Card, you may choose that player. They must reveal one card of their choice from their remaining Whisper hand to you (only you see it).
Theme: Every secret spent reveals the shape of secrets kept.

3) VEIL OF SHADOWS (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Nyxara must be part of the moving group.
Effect: Once per round, when you take a Move action, spend 2 Mana. For this Move action, Nyxara's group ignores all ZOC penalties and may pass through enemy-controlled hexes without requiring a treaty (cannot end movement on an enemy-controlled hex containing enemy units).
Cost: 2 Mana
Theme: The Umbral step between dimensions -- walls and borders mean nothing to shadows.

FACTION RESEARCH (THE SILENT COURT)

STOLEN SECRETS

Cost: 2 Mana, 2 Influence (Research action)
Effect: Once per round, when you play a Whisper Card with WHEN timing, draw 1 Whisper Card immediately.
Theme: Reactions breed intelligence. Every crisis reveals a new thread to pull.

SHADOW NETWORK

Cost: 3 Mana, 1 Gold (Research action)
Effect: Once per round, you may discard 1 Whisper Card from your hand to gain 2 Gold or 2 Influence (your choice).
Theme: Information is currency -- the Silent Court trades in both.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: HALL OF WHISPERS

- Prerequisite: Play 4 Whisper Cards (cumulative across the game).
- Build cost: 4 AP + 4 Gold, 4 Mana, 2 Influence
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: Draw +1 Whisper Card at Round Start. WHEN another player plays a Whisper Card: You may look at their hand. Once per round, you may play a Whisper Card from your hand as if it had any timing window.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "THE SILENT COUP"

Play 4 or more Whisper Cards in a single round.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "UNSEEN HAND"

Gain control of a hex that was previously controlled by another player without initiating an Attack action (via Whisper Card effects, Influence events, or other non-combat means).

Lord Sheet: Auriel, Voice of the World Tree

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Auriel (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d10
- Health: 3
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: Nearly impossible to kill in direct combat -- the hardest defense die in the game combined with solid health. Low offense reflects her role as protector, not aggressor.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 1
Mana: 2
Influence: 3

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR FOREST)

Hallowed Grove (counts as Forest)

- Production: +1 Mana and +1 Influence
- Building permissions: You may build a Grove here, but you may not build a Tower here.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): At Cleanup & Checks, if you control this tile, gain +1 Renown.

ABILITIES

1) THE TREE'S ASSENT (FACTION MECHANIC)

Timing: Once per round, when you cast your vote on a motion during the High Council Phase, before votes are tallied.

Effect: You may sanctify that motion. Your Council Votes, including votes gained from Lobbying, count double on it. Whenever a motion you voted for passes, gain +1 Renown; if it was the motion you sanctified, gain +2 Renown instead.

Limits: Sanctify affects only your own votes and can be used once per round.

Theme: The World Tree does not merely endorse the law; it speaks through you.

2) RADIANT PRESENCE (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: While Auriel is committed to a battle (on the Battle Line or in Reserves), all your units on the Battle Line gain +1 Defense (add +1 to their Defense rolls).

Theme: The Tree's light shields those who fight beside its Voice.

3) EXALTATION (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: Must be your turn during the Action Phase.

Effect: As an ACTION on your turn (costs 0 AP, but consumes your turn), spend 3 Influence to gain +2 Renown immediately.

Cost: 3 Influence, 0 AP (takes your turn)

Theme: Auriel raises a hymn to the World Tree, and the land itself acknowledges her authority.

FACTION RESEARCH (THE RADIANT ACCORD)

LUMINOUS BULWARK

Cost: 2 Mana, 2 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Your units defending a hex that contains one of your buildings gain +1 Defense (stacks with Radiant Presence if Auriel is committed).

Theme: Sacred architecture amplifies the Tree's protection.

SACRED RITE

Cost: 3 Influence, 1 Mana (Research action)

Effect: When you reach 5 Renown for the first time, draw 2 Whisper Cards and gain 1 VP immediately. When you reach 10 Renown for the first time, draw 2 Whisper Cards and gain 1 VP immediately.

Theme: Milestones of faith are rewarded with revelation and glory.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: CATHEDRAL OF RADIANCE

- Prerequisite: Reach 5 Renown.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 4 Gold, 3 Mana, 3 Influence
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: COUNCIL: Your Influence counts double when voting on proposals you initiated. PRODUCTION: Gain +1 Renown if you are currently the Speaker. Units defending this hex gain +2 Defense.

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "RIGHTEOUS MANDATE"

Have 8 or more Renown at Cleanup & Checks.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "VOICE OF AUTHORITY"

Win 2 or more High Council votes in a single round (motions you voted "for" that passed).

Lord Sheet: Thal'rik, the Gatekeeper

First Playable faction reference - full timing and limits from the Lord sheet

STARTING SETUP

STARTING UNITS (IN HOME CITY)

- 2 Infantry
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d6
- Health: 1
- 1 Archer
- Attack: d6
- Defense: d4
- Health: 1
- Notes: Archers on the Battle Line have Pre-Strike (see Combat.md).

LORD UNIT (STARTS IN HOME CITY)

- Thal'rik (Lord / Leader)
- Attack: d8
- Defense: d8
- Health: 3
- Movement Range: 2
- Design note: Balanced combat stats. Thal'rik's power comes from being everywhere at once, not from winning any single fight decisively.

STARTING RESOURCES

Gold: 2
Mana: 3
Influence: 1

POPULATION

Population Cap / Pool: 10 / 7

STARTING AP

Starting AP: 5

UNIQUE STARTING TILE (REPLACES YOUR FOREST)

Rift Anchor (counts as Forest for terrain/movement; also functions as a Portal)

- Production: +1 Mana
- Building permissions: You may build a Tower here, but you may not build a Grove here.
- Special: This tile functions as a Portal for all Portal travel rules. It starts in your home cluster, giving you immediate access to the portal network.
- Owner-only benefit (only while you control it): Once per round, when you use Portal travel from this tile, the AP cost to enter and exit the Portal is 0 (free transit).

ABILITIES

1) DIMENSIONAL ATTUNEMENT (FACTION MECHANIC)

Effect: You may use Portal travel to any Portal on the map, including enemy-controlled Portals, without requiring a treaty or High Council motion. Other players still need the normal treaty/motion to travel to your Portals.

Theme: The Voidborn perceive all gates as one. Borders drawn by mortals do not apply to the spaces between spaces.

2) THRESHOLD WARD (PASSIVE ABILITY)

Effect: When you are defending a hex that contains a Portal (including Rift Anchor), all your units in that battle gain +1 Defense (add +1 to their Defense rolls).

Theme: The dimensional static around a portal warps incoming attacks.

3) RIFT SUMMON (ACTIVE ABILITY)

Requirement: You must control the Portal hex.

Effect: Once per round, when you take a Recruit action, you may place recruited units in any Portal hex you control instead of only in Cities.

Normal recruitment costs, Population costs, and the per-City (or per-Portal) recruit limit of 2 units still apply.

Cost: No extra cost (replaces normal Recruit location restriction)

Theme: The Voidborn pull reinforcements through the gates themselves.

FACTION RESEARCH (THE THRESHOLD)

PLANAR ECHO

Cost: 3 Mana, 1 Gold (Research action)

Effect: Once per round, when you complete a Move action that included Portal travel, gain +1 AP immediately (must be spent this round).

Theme: Momentum carries through the gates -- the Voidborn exit faster than they entered.

VOID ANCHOR

Cost: 2 Mana, 2 Influence (Research action)

Effect: Once per round during the Action Phase, you may spend 1 Mana to place a temporary Void Marker on any hex you control. Until end of round, that hex counts as a Portal for your units only (other players cannot use it for Portal travel). Remove the marker at Cleanup & Checks.

Theme: Thal'rik tears open a temporary rift, extending his network into enemy territory.

LEGENDARY BUILDING: DIMENSIONAL NEXUS

- Prerequisite: Control 2 Portal hexes.
- Build cost: 4 AP + 5 Gold, 5 Mana
- Population: 3
- Upkeep: none
- VP: 2 VP once on construction
- Effect: This City counts as a Portal for all Portal travel rules. Once per round, you may teleport a unit group from this hex to any Portal on the map for 0 AP (you must still control or have a unit at the destination Portal).

FACTION OBJECTIVES

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE (2 VP): "MASTER OF THRESHOLDS"

Control 2 or more Portal hexes (including Rift Anchor) at Cleanup & Checks.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE (1 VP): "EVERYWHERE AT ONCE"

Use Portal travel at least twice in a single round (two separate Move actions that each include Portal transit).

Player Board

Print one per player; use cubes, pencil, or dry-erase markers

Gold

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Mana

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Influence

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

AP

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----

VP

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----

Renown

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

Population Pool

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Population Cap

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Lord HP

0	1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---	---

Production & Upkeep

1. Collect printed terrain and building production.
2. Grow Population where an effect allows; never exceed Population Cap.
3. Pay advanced-unit and active-Law upkeep. Buildings have no recurring resource upkeep.
4. Resolve marked recurring effects and gain any Remnants due.
5. Mark once-per-round abilities as ready for the next round at Cleanup & Checks.

Player Aid

Printable extract of rulebook/Player_Aid.md; page 1

AEONIS: PLAYER AID (FIRST PLAYABLE)

Draft for First Playable - matches the rules chapters as of this writing. The chapter docs remain authoritative.

ROUND SEQUENCE (7 PHASES)

1. Round Start - refresh abilities, reset AP (+ banked AP), draw 2 Whispers, Lords heal to full.
2. Event Phase - draw and resolve one Global Event.
3. Strategy Selection - draft in ascending VP order (2 cards each at 3-4 players, 1 at 5-8); 1 Gold bounty on undrafted cards; lowest card number = initiative.
4. High Council Phase - proposals (1 Influence each), agenda card reveal (free proposal), negotiation, voting, enactment.
5. Action Phase - rotating turns in initiative order; one action per turn until all players pass.
6. Production & Upkeep - collect from controlled hexes/buildings, grow Population, pay advanced-unit/Law upkeep (buildings have none), gain 1 Remnant per controlled Ruins.
7. Cleanup & Checks - release captured Lords, discard Whispers to 7, score objectives and VP checks, check 10 VP threshold, pass Speaker clockwise.

ACTION COSTS

Action | AP | Notes

Move | Path cost | Terrain cost per hex; +1 per enemy ZOC hex (Cavalry: first ZOC hex free); one group per Move

Attack | 2 | One battle round; +1 AP to Press the Attack (one extra round, max once per Attack)

Build | 3 | Plus building's resource cost; Legendary Building: 4 AP

Recruit | 1 | Up to 2 units in one controlled City; once per City per round

Research | 1 | Tier I only in First Playable; plus resource cost (default 2 Mana); grants 1 Remnant

Trade | 1 | Initiate once per round; Market allows one at 0 AP

Strategy Card primary | Varies | Printed on card; once per round; others may then buy the secondary (no turn used)

Play ACTION Whisper | 0 | Uses your turn

Claim Artifact | 1 | Requires your unit on the Artifact Site hex

Pass | - | Out for the round; bank up to 2 AP

Free action (0 AP, doesn't use your turn): purge 3 Remnants on your turn to draw 1 Artifact Card.

UNIT STATS

Unit | Attack | Defense | HP | Move | Notes

Infantry | d6 | d6 | 1 | 1 | 1 Gold, 1 Population

Cavalry | d8 | d6 | 2 | 2 | 2 Gold, 2 Population; ignores first ZOC hex per Move (flanking)

Archer | d6 | d4 | 1 | 1 | 1 Gold + 1 Mana, 1 Population; Pre-Strike on the Battle Line

Lords (occupy 0 Population; captured at 0 HP: captor gains +1 VP, +2 Renown; released at Cleanup):

Lord | Race | Attack | Defense | HP | Move | Identity

Cassian | Human | d6 | d8 | 3 | 2 | Diplomat

Seraphel | Human | d10 | d6 | 3 | 2 | Glass cannon

Vharok | Human | d8 | d10 | 4 | 1 | Slow tank

Elyndra | Elven | d6 | d8 | 4 | 2 | Resilient guardian

Rakhis | Djinnborn | d8 | d6 | 3 | 3 | Fast raider

Nyxara | Umbral | d10 | d4 | 2 | 2 | Assassin

Auriel | Luminari | d6 | d10 | 3 | 2 | Faith tank

Thal'rik | Voidborn | d8 | d8 | 3 | 2 | Portal master

LAUNCH-LORD SIGNATURES

Lord | Signature reminder

Cassian | One off-turn 0-AP Trade; one binding current-motion vote promise per round

Seraphel | +1 virtual sigil in every school; second paid Research in the same turn once per round

Vharok | Built hexes may Hold the Walls; +1 defending Battle Line slot there

Elyndra | One 1-AP group Move between any two controlled Forests per round

Rakhis | Deserts cost 1; one pre-Pre-Strike retreat per battle (normal ZOC)

Nyxara | Draw 3 Whispers at Round Start; hand limit 8

Auriel | Sanctify one motion per round: own votes x2; +2 Renown if supported and passed

Thal'rik | Portal travel to any Portal without permission

TERRAIN

Terrain | Move cost | Production | Notes

Plains | 1 AP | +1 Population | Farm upgrades to +2

Forest | 1 AP | +1 Mana | Grove upgrades to +3; defensive bonus for units ending movement here

Mountain | 2 AP | +1 Gold | Mine upgrades to +3

Player Aid

Printable extract of rulebook/Player_Aid.md; page 2

Desert | 2 AP | +1 Influence | Embassy upgrades to +3; units lose 1 Population if they spend more than 2 turns here
Lake | Impassable | - | Bridge makes it passable (1 AP, no production)
City | 1 AP | +2 Population + various | Recruitment hub; +1 AP/round to controller (max +2 from Cities)
Ruins | - | Varies | Controller gains 1 Remnant per round
Portal | 1 AP enter/exit | None | Portal-to-Portal travel 0 AP (destination must be neutral or yours)

BUILDINGS

3 AP to Build (Legendary: 4 AP), plus the costs below. "Pop" = Population occupied while the building exists.

Building | Where | Cost | Pop | Effect
Farm | Plains | 2 Gold | 1 | Plains produces +2 Population; +2 Population Cap
Mine | Mountains | 3 Gold | 1 | Mountain produces +3 Gold
Grove | Forests | 2 Mana | 1 | Forest produces +3 Mana
Embassy | Deserts | 3 Influence | 1 | Desert produces +3 Influence
Tower | Any tile | 4 Gold | 1 | +1 Defense in hex; influence 2 hexes out; controls a Portal if built on one
Fortress | Any tile | 5 Gold, 2 Mana | 2 | +2 Defense in hex; attacks on it are always Sieges
Bridge | Lake | 4 Gold | 0 | Lake becomes passable/controllable; needs adjacent controlled non-Lake hex
Guild Hall | City | 4 Gold, 2 Influence | 1 | +1 AP per round
Forge | City | 6 Gold, 1 Mana | 1 | +1 unit per Recruit here (once/round); units here cost -1 Gold (min 1)
Academy | City | 4 Gold, 4 Mana | 2 | School Specialty of choice; -1 Mana on one Research per round (min 0)
Bank | City | 5 Gold | 1 | Once per round at Production: convert 2 Mana->3 Gold, 2 Gold->3 Mana, or 2 Gold->3 Influence
Castle | City | 8 Gold | 2 | +3 Population Cap; +2 Defense in this City
Market | City | 2 Gold, 2 Influence | 1 | Once per round: initiate one Trade at 0 AP
Legendary | Your City | Per Lord sheet | 3 | Unique per Lord; prerequisite; 2 VP once on build (+ 1 VP once to City captor); +2 Renown on build

Slots: 1 building per basic terrain tile; 2 per City (3 with research).

COMBAT SEQUENCE (ONE BATTLE ROUND PER ATTACK ACTION)

Battle Line Cap: 3 (standard hex) / 5 (City or Fortress). Committed units beyond the cap are Reserves.

1. Reinforce Battle Lines - promote Reserves up to the cap.
2. Archer Pre-Strike - attacking Archers roll first, then defending Archers; each targets an enemy line unit.
3. Attacker Strike - each line unit picks a target: Attack die vs. Defense die; Attack > Defense = 1 damage (ties: nothing).
4. Defender Counterstrike - same, for surviving defenders.
5. Retreat Check - attacker decides first. Defender may retreat from standard hexes only (to an adjacent controlled hex) - never from Cities/Fortresses.
6. Victory Check - a side with no committed units left loses; otherwise the battle pauses.

Press the Attack: +1 AP after step 6 for one extra battle round (max once per Attack action).

Aftermath: attacker victory = immediate control; occupy with up to the cap. Sieges (Fortress always; City if defender Holds the Walls) persist across rounds; each side may add up to 3 units per siege round.

HIGH COUNCIL

Sequence: agenda opens -> proposals (1 Influence, max 1 per player) -> Speaker reveals 1 agenda card (anyone may propose it free) -> negotiation -> vote motions in order proposed -> enact.

Vote math:

- Base: 1 vote per player
- +1 vote at 5+ Renown; +1 more at 10+ Renown
- Lobbying: 2 Influence = +1 vote (this motion only; minimum spend 2; declared in initiative order)
- Passes on strict majority of votes cast - ties fail
- Passing your own motion: +1 Renown

VP SOURCES

Source | VP
Public objective (each) | 2
Secret objective (each) | 2
Coronation Rite (control Seat + Lord present) | +1 per Cleanup; third total Rite +2 once
Capture an enemy Lord | +1 (plus +2 Renown)
Construct your Legendary Building | 2 once; a later City captor scores 1 once
Gain a VP artifact (Crown of Aeonis, Eternal Forge, Shard of the Throne, Imperial Seal) | 1 once; max 2 scorers per artifact
Title first claimed (Hero of the Realm, Magister of Mana) | 2
Imperial Mandate primary while controlling the Imperial Seat | 1

Player Aid

Printable extract of rulebook/Player_Aid.md; page 3

10 VP triggers the final round (8 VP short variant). Highest VP at end of that round wins; ties: most Renown, then most Influence. Scoring VP from any source: draw 1 Whisper Card.

WHISPER TIMING WINDOWS

Timing | When you can play it | Uses your turn?

ACTION | On your turn in the Action Phase, instead of your action (0 AP) | Yes

COMBAT | During the named step of a battle you are in | No

COUNCIL | At the named moment of the High Council Phase | No

WHEN [X] | Immediately after the described trigger occurs | No

Max 1 Whisper per timing window per occurrence. Sabotage cancels a Whisper as it is played and cannot be Sabotaged.

KEY LIMITS

- Whisper hand limit: 7 (discard down at Cleanup & Checks)
- Battle Line Cap: 3 standard hex / 5 City or Fortress
- Recruit: once per City per round; up to 2 units per Recruit action
- AP banking: max 2 AP carried over when you pass
- Secret objectives: max 3 unscored in hand
- Public objectives: shared row; score at most 1 per Cleanup, each card once per player. Cumulative progress begins when the card is revealed.
- Lord Equipment artifacts: max 2 per Lord
- City AP bonus: max +2 from Cities
- Trade: initiate once per round
- Council proposals: 1 motion per player per round (agenda card is extra)
- Strategy Card primary: once per round; each secondary once per player per round
- Population: starting Cap 10; global maximum 25 (default)
- Building slots: 1 per basic tile; 2 per City (3 with research)